The Everyday Abilities Review Checklist

What to write down, gather and ask about while Dad is managing well.

Dad still does most things himself, and nothing on this page assumes otherwise. It lists what to put on paper now, so the family has a dated starting point to compare against later. Check what you've done. Anything unchecked is simply not written down yet. It says nothing about Dad.

Write down

- [ ] What Dad does on his own in an ordinary week: bathing, dressing, eating, using the bathroom, getting around.
- [ ] The help he already gets, from whom, and roughly when each thing started.
- [ ] How he gets around, at home and out, and anything he uses or holds to stand up, sit down or steady himself.
- [ ] What you've noticed about memory, mood or how he communicates, written as one thing that happened, not what you think it means.
- [ ] Anything about eating, swallowing, continence or skin you'd like a professional to look at. If there's nothing, write “nothing noted.”
- [ ] Today's date on the page, and next to each note, who saw it.

Gather

- [ ] Any current care instructions, and recent letters or summaries from his doctor.
- [ ] A current list of everything he takes: prescriptions, over-the-counter medicines, vitamins and supplements. [1]
- [ ] The therapies or services he already uses, and who provides them.

Ask

- [ ] Dad, first: what he feels he does easily, and where a hand is welcome.
- [ ] The rest of the family: what each person has noticed changing over time, and when.
- [ ] The prescriber or the pharmacist: your medication questions, written down. Change nothing on your own. [1]
- [ ] His doctor, or another professional he sees: which changes they'd want to hear about, and when they'd like to look again.
- [ ] For each question still open, who it goes to: his doctor, his pharmacist, a therapist or your care consultant.

What this checklist doesn't do

It helps you write down, gather and ask. It doesn't say what any of it means, whether anything has changed, or when Dad should be looked at again. Those belong to the professionals who know him, and to the next step below.

Ready for the next step?

You've checked what's written down, what's gathered and what's been asked. The care interview takes it from there: it goes through Dad's everyday life area by area, including the parts a one-page list leaves out, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Items marked 1 follow the Family Caregiver Alliance's guide to medications; the rest come from the Family Care Roadmap's own working list for this step.

1. Family Caregiver Alliance, Caregiver's Guide to Medications and Aging